Except *that* debate too has already taken place, six years ago, and even then it was four years overdue. First published in December 2006, the essays in Part I of this book deal at length with the trial, the miscarriage of justice, the fact that Afzal Guru went unrepresented in the trial court, the ways in which real leads were never followed, and the insidious role of the media at the time. Part II of this new edition is a compilation of essays and analyses written after the execution. The introduction to the first edition ends by saying 'Therefore, this book, offered in hope.' This time, it is offered in anger.

In these very vengeful times, the impatient may well say: Chuck the details and the legal minutiae. Was he guilty or was he not? Did the Indian government hang an innocent man?

Anyone who takes the trouble to read this book would have to come to the conclusion that Afzal Guru had not been proven guilty of the crime he was accused of committing—of being one of the conspirators in the Attack on the Indian Parliament or, more fashionably, the 'Attack on Indian Democracy'. (Contrary to the elaborate misinformation put out in the media, even the prosecution never accused him of being one of the attackers, or of killing anybody. He was only tried for being an accomplice, a mere foot soldier.) Even as the Supreme Court convicted him of this crime and sentenced him to death, in its controversial judgement that invoked satisfying 'the collective conscience of the society' as one of its reasons for putting a man to death, it also went out of its way to say that the evidence before it was not direct, but only circumstantial.

Terrorism experts and other analysts have loftily glossed over this by saying that in cases like these the 'full truth' would always be elusive. In the case of the Attack on Parliament, this certainly seems to be what has happened. The 'truth' seems to have eluded us entirely. Logically, that should have raised the juridical principle of 'reasonable doubt'. It did not. A man whose guilt was by no means established beyond reasonable doubt was hanged.

Let's concede that an Attack on the Indian Parliament *does* amount to an Attack on Democracy. Was the 1983 Nellie massacre of three thousand 'illegal Bangladeshis' not an attack on Indian Democracy? Or the massacre of more than three thousand Sikhs on the streets of Delhi in 1984? Was the demolition of the Babri Masjid in 1992 not an attack on Indian Democracy? Was the Shiv Sena-led slaughter of thousands of Muslims in Mumbai in 1993 not an Attack on Indian Democracy? What about the 2002 pogrom against